

WHO Infant Feeding and Breastfeeding Guidelines:

1. Exclusive Breastfeeding:

WHO recommends that infants should be exclusively breastfed for the first six months of life to achieve optimal growth, development, and health. No water, formula, or other foods should be given unless medically indicated.

2. Initiation of Breastfeeding:

Initiate breastfeeding within the first hour of birth. Skin-to-skin contact immediately after delivery stimulates the release of prolactin and oxytocin, which helps with early milk letdown.

3. Colostrum:

The early thick yellow milk (colostrum) produced in the first few days is rich in antibodies, proteins, and immune factors. It acts as the baby's first natural vaccine and should never be discarded.

4. Latch and Positioning:

A good latch is critical to prevent nipple pain and ensure efficient milk transfer. The baby's mouth should be wide open, with the lower lip flanged outward, covering most of the areola (not just the nipple).